LA CUCINA ITALIANA - SEMPLICE ITALIAN KITCHEN | BUDGET-FRIENDLY ITALIAN

An Easy Italian Lentil and Tomato Rag (Rich, Meaty & Budget-Friendly Bolognese)

Rich, hearty, and $1.40 per serving! Make this Easy Italian Lentil and Tomato Rag in 40 minutes with pantry lentils, soffritto, and red wine. Free PDF card!

Prep: 10 mins | Cook: 30 mins | Total: 40 mins | Yield: 6 servings ($1.40/serving) | Calories: 450 kcal

INGREDIENTS CHECKLIST

[ ] 220g (1 cup dried) Dried Brown or Green Castelluccio Lentils (or 2 cans cooked) (rinsed)
[ ] 2 cups total Finely Minced Soffritto (1 Onion, 2 Carrots, 2 Celery Stalks)
[ ] 2 tbsp paste, 1 can (400g) crushed Tomato Paste & Crushed San Marzano Tomatoes
[ ] 120ml (1/2 cup) Dry Red Wine (or Balsamic Vinegar Splash)
[ ] 3 cups broth, 3 cloves garlic Vegetable Broth, Rosemary, Bay Leaf & Garlic
[ ] 450g (1 lb) Pappardelle, Tagliatelle, or Rigatoni Pasta

STEP-BY-STEP CULINARY INSTRUCTIONS

Step 1: Caramelize the Finely Minced Soffritto [8 mins]
Warm 3 tablespoons olive oil in a Dutch oven over medium heat. Cook finely minced onion, carrot, and celery for 8 minutes until golden and sweet.

Step 2: Toast Tomato Paste & Deglaze with Red Wine [4 mins]
Add minced garlic, rosemary, and tomato paste; stir for 2 minutes until brick-red. Pour in dry red wine and simmer until reduced by half.

Step 3: Simmer Lentils Until Tender & Velvety [24 mins]
Add rinsed brown lentils, crushed tomatoes, bay leaf, and 3 cups warm broth. Simmer gently covered for 22 to 25 minutes until lentils are tender and the sauce is thick and glossy.

Step 4: Toss with Al Dente Pasta & Parmigiano
Toss the bubbling lentil rag with al dente pappardelle or rigatoni, a splash of pasta water, and freshly grated Parmigiano-Reggiano (or nutritional yeast/olive oil for vegan).

CHEF'S PRO TIPS & STORAGE

* Cut your carrot, celery, and onion into tiny lentil-sized dice (brunoise) so the vegetables and lentils merge into a single unified, meaty Bolognese texture.
* This rag freezes beautifully for up to 3 months-make a double batch for effortless weeknight pasta or lasagna!